ASSOCIATE PRODUCT MANAGER — CASE STUDY

Lending Product • Account Aggregator Ecosystem

Take-home mini-project | Suggested effort: 3–4 hours | No single correct answer

1. How to approach this exercise

This is not a test of how much you already know about the Account Aggregator (AA) ecosystem. Section 2 gives you everything you need. What we are evaluating is the way you think as a product manager: how you frame an ambiguous problem, find the root cause in data, prioritise, and connect what you build to the outcome the business cares about.

What to submit: A short deck (8–12 slides) or a written document. Be concise. We would rather see sharp reasoning on a few points than a shallow pass over everything. State your assumptions clearly wherever the brief is silent — we left gaps on purpose.

Walkthrough: You will present your thinking for ~30 minutes, followed by discussion. Expect us to push on your trade-offs.

2. Background

Who we are

We are a B2B fintech operating as a Technology Service Provider (TSP) on the Account Aggregator framework. Lenders — banks and NBFCs — come to us because pulling a customer's bank data and turning it into a credit decision is hard, regulated, and slow to build in-house. We do it for them. Our two flagship products are the Bank Statement Analyser (BSA) and the Early Warning System (EWS).

How data reaches us

When a lender (our client, the FIU) wants to assess a loan applicant, the applicant is asked to consent to sharing their bank data. That request and the resulting data flow along a fixed path:

FIP → AA → FIU → TSP

The bank (FIP) releases the data, the Account Aggregator carries it under the user's consent, the lender (FIU) receives it, and we (the TSP) analyse it. Nothing moves without an active consent artifact granted by the user. This consent step is both our greatest strength — it is secure, auditable, and user-permissioned — and, as you will see, the single biggest leak in the funnel.

Glossary

Term	What it means in our world
AA (Account Aggregator)	An RBI-regulated consent manager that lets a user securely share their financial data between institutions. It moves data; it never stores or reads it.
FIP (Financial Information Provider)	The institution that holds the user's data — e.g. their bank. It releases data only after consent.
FIU (Financial Information User)	The institution that consumes the data to make a decision — e.g. our lender client underwriting a loan.

Term	What it means in our world
TSP (Technology Service Provider)	Us. We build the technology that sits on top of the AA rails and turns raw data into decisions for the FIU.
BSA (Bank Statement Analyser)	Our product that converts a user's raw bank-statement data into structured insights — income, expenses, EMIs, bounces, balances — for underwriting.
EWS (Early Warning System)	Our product that monitors a borrower's account signals after disbursal to flag rising default risk early.
Consent artifact	The digital, revocable permission a user grants in the AA app specifying what data, for what purpose, and for how long.

3. The scenario

"LendWell" is one of our largest NBFC clients. They use our BSA to underwrite unsecured personal loans sourced entirely through their mobile app. Last week their Head of Credit escalated two problems on the same call:

Complaint 1 — "We are losing applicants before we even see their data." Too many applicants start the AA consent journey and never finish it. LendWell is paying to acquire these users and watching them disappear at the data-sharing step.

Complaint 2 — "When we do get the data, we still reject most people." Approval rates are low, especially for new-to-credit and thin-file applicants. LendWell suspects our BSA isn't surfacing enough signal to confidently say yes to these customers — so they play safe and decline.

LendWell has hinted they are evaluating a competitor. Renewal is in one quarter. Your product — the lending product — owns the end-to-end journey from consent to credit decision, so this lands on your desk.

Sample monthly funnel (LendWell)

This is representative data LendWell shared. Treat the numbers as real and look for where value leaks.

Stage	Users	Step conversion
Applicants who reach the AA consent screen	100,000	—
Approved consent (linked account + approved)	55,000	**55%**
Successful data fetch from the FIP	46,750	85%
BSA insight generated	46,750	100%
Loan approved by LendWell's underwriting	14,025	**30%**
Loan disbursed	12,622	90%

A few more facts you may use: average disbursed loan size is ₹80,000; LendWell earns roughly 6% net take on a disbursed loan; their blended cost to acquire an applicant who reaches the consent screen is about ₹250.

4. Your task

You are the APM on the lending product. Work through the questions below. They build on each other.

Q1. Frame the problem

- Break the funnel down and identify where the largest, most addressable losses are. Are LendWell's two complaints the real problems, or symptoms of something else?
- Separate what is in our control (the TSP) from what sits with the AA, the FIP, or LendWell. Be honest about it — owning the wrong problem wastes a quarter.

Q2. Size the opportunity (estimation)

We want to see structured estimation, not a precise answer. State every assumption.

- Estimate the monthly revenue LendWell loses today purely because of consent-stage drop-off (the gap between the 100,000 who arrive and the 55,000 who approve).
- If we lifted consent approval from 55% to 75% with everything else held constant, estimate the additional loans disbursed per month and the additional annual take-home revenue for LendWell. Why might "everything else held constant" be the wrong assumption?

Q3. Map business outcomes to product outcomes

This is the heart of the exercise. The business outcome LendWell cares about is more good loans at acceptable risk, and the outcome we care about is keeping LendWell from churning. Translate those into product outcomes you can actually move and measure.

- For each business outcome, define the product outcome and the metric that proves it (e.g. consent completion rate, data-fetch success rate, approval rate on thin-file segments, time-to-decision, false-positive rate on EWS).
- Be clear about which metric is your primary success metric and which are guardrails you must not harm (for example, approving more loans must not blow up early defaults).

Q4. Find the root cause

- Lay out how you would investigate the 45% consent drop-off. What would you instrument, what would you pull from logs, and what would you ask users in research? Name two or three hypotheses you would expect to find (think: confusing AA app handoff, FIP downtime, account-discovery failures, drop-off on specific banks).
- For Complaint 2, describe how you would test whether the BSA genuinely lacks signal for thin-file customers, versus LendWell's credit policy simply being conservative.

Q5. Propose and prioritise solutions

- Put forward a set of solution ideas across the funnel. They can span our products (BSA, EWS) and the journey we orchestrate (the consent experience, retries on FIP failure, new insights for thin-file applicants).
- Prioritise them. Use any framework you like, but make the reasoning visible — what is high impact and low effort, and what is a bet.

Q6. Build the roadmap

- Lay out a roadmap of about two quarters. For each item, state the product outcome it targets (tie it back to Q3) — not just the feature, but the result it should produce.
- Tell us what you would ship first and why, given the renewal is one quarter away.

Q7. Risks, trade-offs and guardrails

- We operate on user consent and regulated data. Call out the compliance and trust risks in your plan — consent scope, data minimisation, what we may and may not do with the data, and what happens on consent revocation.
- Name one trade-off in your roadmap you are genuinely unsure about, and tell us how you would resolve it with data after launch.

5. What we are looking for

There is no answer key. Strong submissions tend to share these traits:

- Problem framing before solutioning — you separate symptom from cause and you are precise about what you own.
- Numerical fluency — you are comfortable with a funnel and a back-of-the-envelope estimate, and your assumptions are reasonable and stated.
- A clean line from business outcome to product outcome to metric — nothing on your roadmap is there “just because.”
- Awareness that we sit in a regulated, consent-first ecosystem — you treat user trust as a feature, not a footnote.
- Prioritisation under a real constraint — you can say what you would drop, not only what you would do.